Item rule – Poisons · SRD 5.2.1

A **poison** works by its **delivery type**: **contact**, **ingested**, **inhaled** or **injury**. The victim makes a **Constitution save**: a failure inflicts the poison's effect (damage, **Poisoned** condition...).

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Four types: contact, ingested, inhaled, injury.
2. **Constitution** save against the poison's DC.
3. **Poisoned**: disadvantage on attacks and checks.
4. Injury: coat with a **bonus action**, works on hit.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 lists poisons by delivery type, with price and DC; Poisoned remains a disadvantage condition.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't say how long a contact poison stays active. Fix: until touched or washed off.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the poison's smell, color or taste.

Step 1 – Choose the type:

Contact, ingested, inhaled or injury.

Step 2 – Deliver:

Injury: bonus action on a weapon. Inhaled: 5-ft cube, holding breath doesn't help.

Step 3 – Save:

Constitution against the poison's DC.

Step 4 – Effect:

Damage, Poisoned, Unconscious, etc. depending on the poison.

Step 5 – Treat:

Antitoxin: advantage on saves against poison, 1 hour.

Example: an assassin coats a blade (injury). Léa fails her Con save: 3d6 poison damage.

Poison (type, price)	DC	Effect
Assassin's Blood (ingested, 150 GP)	10 Con	1d12 poison, Poisoned 24 h
Burnt Othur Fumes (inhaled, 500 GP)	13 Con	3d6 poison, then 1d6 per failure
Crawler Mucus (contact, 200 GP)	13 Con	Poisoned, Paralyzed 1 min
Essence of Ether (inhaled, 300 GP)	15 Con	Poisoned 8 h, Unconscious
Midnight Tears (ingested, 1,500 GP)	17 Con	9d6 poison at midnight
Purple Worm Poison (injury, 2,000 GP)	21 Con	10d6 poison
Truth Serum (ingested, 150 GP)	11 Con	Poisoned 1 h; can't lie

⚠ Common questions:

How many types?

Four.

Which roll?

Constitution save.

What does Poisoned do?

Disadvantage on attacks and checks.

How do I avoid it?

Antitoxin: advantage for 1 hour.

How much is Antitoxin?

50 GP.

How much is basic poison?

100 GP.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Partial dose

Does a partial dose work? **Option**: reduced effect.

Resistance

Dwarves resist poison. **Option**: advantage on the save.

Magical poison

Against an object? **Option**: no effect, objects are immune.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Inhaled

Holding your breath doesn't help.

Injury

Only piercing or slashing damage delivers it.

Objects

Immune to poison.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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